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Evening Ex

No. 33,835 (EST. 1879) WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 21, 1987



JASPER

Why he could
never hold
down a job

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CITY SOUL

All the latest
news and vie

EXCLUSIVE

Undercover agent
claims by attorney

US TRIAL MAN FACES SECRET FILM

By COLIN CRAIG

ALLEGED secretly-taped meetings with an undercover US customs officer could mean a 50-year jail sentence for Aberdeen business man Frank Christie.

For the American authorities are relying on what they claim are incriminating statements made by Mr Christie (50) to convict him of illegally attempting to obtain five million dollars worth of oil equipment for Libya.

Man arrested over schoolgirl stabbing

DETECTIVES today arrested a man in connection with the stabbing of 10-year-old Catherine Humphrey.

The new development

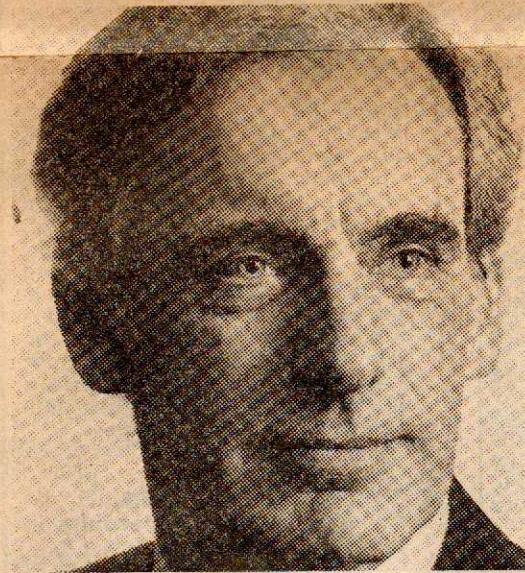
Catherine was at one stage clinging to life in the hospital's intensive care unit.

But last night — although still critically



For the American authorities on what they claim are incriminating statements made by Mr Christie (50) to convict him of illegally attempting to obtain five million dollars worth of oil equipment for Libya.

Assistant US prosecuting attorney Phillip Halpern in San Diego exclusively told the Evening Express that Mr Christie's Libyan connection had been under investigation for months, with help from Interpol and New Scotland Yard.



FRANK CHRISTIE ... in jail.

Mr Christie, of Christie Noble Services, Mile-End Lane, Midstocket, is currently in jail in San Diego having so far failed to raise 300,000 dollars bail.

Mr Halpern gave details of the US customs undercover operation designed to cut off supplies to Libya.

He said that the US embargo on supplies to the country was part of action against their support of terrorism.

Oil-related equipment was vital to exploit Libya's oilfields — which in turn financed terrorism, he said.

Mr Christie, he said, had been videoed and taped in meetings with customs agent Dan Supnick, who had been posing as someone who could help in avoiding the embargo.

Case

It is alleged that Mr Christie would have acted as middle man, routing the equipment to Libya via Aberdeen.

"The case will consist of video-taped meetings between him and a customs agent and others," said Mr Halpern.

The husband and wife owners of an oil company have also been charged in connection with the case.

"There is potential for further arrests," added Mr Halpern.

"The meeting was set up to discuss an approximately five million dollar deal to Libya.

Date

Mr Halpern said Mr Christie had been in contact with Libyan authorities.

US customs will allege Mr Christie went to the US as the middle man in the deal he said.

The case was a significant one according to Mr Halpern, and could mean a 50-year jail sentence if Mr Christie was found guilty of all counts.

The case will go before a grand jury in the next few weeks with a trial date being set in about two months.

If it goes to trial it will be held before a judge and 12-strong jury in

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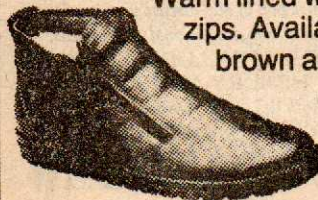
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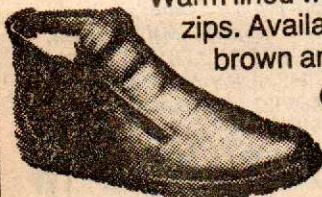
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(Corner of Skene Sq. Buses 9, 10, 21 and 23 to door)

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● See "Expert warns
of trade risk" on Page 7.

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